

Los Angeles Unified School District
Office of the Inspector General

Performance Audit of Contractor Fingerprinting Compliance for Student Safety

26-1018
August 13, 2026

William D. Hoffman
Inspector General





Los Angeles Unified School District

Office of the Inspector General

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August 13, 2026

Board of Education
Los Angeles Unified School District
333 S. Beaudry Avenue, 24th Floor
Los Angeles, CA 90017

RE: Performance Audit of Contractor Fingerprinting Compliance for Student Safety

Dear President Schmerelson and Members of the Board,

Enclosed is the final report on our Performance Audit on Contractor Fingerprinting Compliance for Student Safety.

Please contact our office with any questions regarding this report.

Sincerely,

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Attachment

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Los Angeles Unified School District's (District) Office of the Inspector General (OIG) conducted a performance audit to assess whether contractors providing services to District students complied with fingerprinting and criminal background check requirements established by the California Education Code (CA Ed. Code), District policy, and contract provisions.¹ The audit also assessed whether the District established oversight mechanisms and school-level practices to prevent unauthorized individuals from interacting with students.

Our audit of 20 selected contractors found that background checks were conducted for all 223 sampled staff members before their assignment at designated school sites. However, we identified gaps in documentation, verification, and oversight that limited the District's ability to confirm compliance with fingerprinting and clearance requirements. Addressing these areas provides opportunities to strengthen the District's contractor background-check and clearance-verification process and better support the District, as summarized in the following key conclusions and recommendations from our audit.

Key Conclusions:

- An out-of-state contractor did not obtain the required California Department of Justice (DOJ) fingerprint clearance for staff members assigned to work with District students and did not submit the required Fingerprint and Criminal Background Check Certification Form (Certification Form).
- Varying program practices, unclear expectations, and reliance on system-based tracking tools instead of required written certification resulted in 8 of 20 sampled contractors not submitting required fingerprinting Certification Forms. Only 2 contractors submitted these forms at the time of contract execution, and most late submissions were received only after the audit inquiry.
- Incomplete entry of staff clearance information in the Beyond the Bell (BTB) Attendance App (BTB App) resulted in only 54 percent of 97 sampled after-school program staff having clearance recorded, while 27 percent had no record in either the BTB App or SharePoint.² This was caused by inconsistent tracking methods, technical or access issues, and incomplete data updates, thereby limiting the reliability of centralized clearance records.
- Varying interpretations of District fingerprinting and background check responsibilities and requirements resulted in Certification Forms not being consistently obtained or maintained across contract sponsor departments.

¹ California Education Code (CA Ed. Code) 45125.1 requires contractors to ensure that any employee who may have unsupervised contact with students undergoes a fingerprint-based criminal background check through the California Department of Justice (DOJ) before beginning work. District policy refers to Fingerprinting and Criminal Background Compliance for Contractors Bulletins that establish the requirements and responsibilities for ensuring contractors obtain DOJ fingerprint clearance and submit written certification before providing services to students: BUL-3872.0 (August 7, 2007), BUL-3872.1 (December 16, 2024), and BUL-3872.2 (August 11, 2025).

² The BTB App is a centralized system for District oversight staff to verify that after-school program employees meet required health, safety, and training standards. SharePoint is a Microsoft web-based platform used by the District for document management, collaboration, and information sharing.

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- District divisions did not consistently coordinate or fulfill their responsibilities for collecting, maintaining, and sharing contractor clearance documentation, resulting in missing records and gaps in oversight.
 - Contractors did not submit updated staff clearance rosters, and contract requirements did not mandate such updates, resulting in outdated District records that did not consistently reflect current staff working at school sites, and limiting the ability to verify that only cleared individuals were assigned.
 - Contract language across programs did not consistently incorporate all District fingerprinting requirements, such as ongoing monitoring, DOJ subsequent arrest notifications, and reporting obligations, resulting in contracts that did not fully reflect policy expectations and contributing to inconsistent implementation and unclear contractor requirements, as well as contract sponsors' oversight roles and responsibilities.
 - School sites implemented different levels of contractor clearance controls, resulting in inconsistent reliance on District processes and contractors, as well as limited document checks. Required records, including Certification Forms, staff rosters, and sign-in logs, were often missing or incomplete, thus limiting the District's ability to reliably verify contractor clearance.

Summary of Recommendations:

- Recommendation No. 1 - Ensure out-of-state contractors obtain the required DOJ fingerprint clearance, submit Certification Forms, and maintain supporting documentation prior to providing services.
- Recommendation No. 2 - Strengthen controls to improve contractor compliance by standardizing the Certification Form submission process, clearly communicating requirements, ensuring consistent tracking and retention, distinguishing internal systems from required contractual documentation, providing contractor guidance, and implementing periodic monitoring to verify timely submission and compliance.
- Recommendation No. 3 - If an alternative system, such as the BTB App, is used for clearance tracking, align contract language and policy requirements with the system's use, and implement a formal monitoring process to ensure complete and accurate entry of staff clearance data.
- Recommendation No. 4 - Standardize implementation of fingerprinting requirements across all contract sponsor departments, including expectations for Certification Forms, supported by coordination, training, and accountability mechanisms to strengthen compliance and oversight.
- Recommendation No. 5 - Improve coordination among, and accountability of, District divisions by defining responsibilities and standardizing the collection, retention, and sharing of contractor clearance documentation to ensure a uniform process and reliable recordkeeping across the District.

- Recommendation No. 6 - Establish a standardized process for submission, review, and retention of updated staff clearance rosters when personnel changes occur and incorporate the contractor requirement of submitting updated clearance rosters into contracts.
- Recommendation No. 7 - Standardize contract language across programs to align with District policies, while accounting for program-specific requirements and procedures, and clearly define contractors' compliance obligations.
- Recommendation No. 8 - Develop standardized procedures and training to improve school-site implementation of contractor clearance controls, supported by strengthened documentation and monitoring practices.

INTRODUCTION

The District is responsible for ensuring that contractors who work with students comply with fingerprinting and criminal background check requirements established in the CA Ed. Code. These requirements are reinforced through District bulletins and standard contract provisions, which collectively require contractor employees to complete a background clearance prior to any student interaction, provide a written certification of compliance, and ensure that individuals with disqualifying criminal histories are not assigned to District sites.

The OIG conducted a risk assessment to identify contract types most susceptible to non-compliance with background clearance requirements. Contracts involving non-District personnel working directly with students were assessed as high risk due to the volume of external staff, decentralized work-order processes, and large student populations served.

Based on this assessment, the OIG selected 20 of 96 active contracts as of June 30, 2025, across four program categories—After-School Programs, Tutoring Services, Black Student Achievement Program (BSAP), and Partners for Student Success (PFSS)—for detailed testing (see Exhibit A for a list of sampled contracts). The table below summarizes the sampled contracts by contract/program category, including the contract sponsor/department, the number of contracts tested, and the total contract value. Collectively, the sampled contracts represent approximately \$86 million across the four programs.

Contract/Program Category	Contract Sponsor/Department	Total Contracts Selected	Total Contract Value
After-School Programs	Beyond the Bell Branch (BTB)	5	\$ 32,720,000
Tutoring Services	Division of Instruction (DOI)	2	31,962,790
BSAP	Educational Transformation Office (ETO)	9	19,884,312
PFSS	Office of Development & Civic Engagement (ODCE)	4	1,440,555
Total		20	\$ 86,007,657

RESULTS OF AUDIT

Objective 1: Determine whether contractors complied with the CA Ed. Code, District policies and procedures, and contract requirements for fingerprinting and criminal background checks.

For the 20 sampled contracts, the OIG compiled data on the number of schools served and contractor staffing levels to establish the testing population. From this population, 52 school sites were randomly selected for review, and 223 contractor staff assigned to those sites were identified for detailed testing. The table below summarizes the total population of schools served and staff associated with the 20 sampled contracts, as well as the distribution of selected schools and staff across the four contract categories.

Contract/Program Category	Total Schools Served (a)	Total Assigned Staff Members	Total Schools Selected for Testing	Total Staff Members Selected for Testing
After-School Programs	87	695	10	97
Tutoring Services	329	1,160	17	45
BSAP	148	201	17	47
PFSS	54	211	8	34
Total	618	2,267	52	223
<i>(a) Excludes home-based/virtual services and college campus tours, which could cover students from multiple schools, depending on the type of contract and/or services.</i>				

To evaluate contractors' compliance with fingerprinting and background check requirements, the OIG performed the following procedures:

- Interviewed each contractor to obtain an understanding of their processes for complying with fingerprinting and background check requirements.
- Reviewed internal control questionnaires completed by each contractor to assess documented procedures, onboarding controls, fingerprint tracking practices, certification processes, and communication protocols with the District.
- Reviewed hire dates, first dates of work assignment, and work schedules or school site assignments for 223 sampled staff members.
- Verified whether background checks were completed for each sampled staff member by reviewing supporting documentation, including Live Scan submission receipts, Applicant Tracking Identifier (ATI) numbers, and DOJ clearance notices.³

³ Live Scan is an electronic fingerprinting process that digitally submits fingerprints to the DOJ and FBI for a criminal background check. The Applicant Tracking Identifier (ATI) number is a unique identifier assigned to each fingerprint submission to enable the DOJ to route results back to the correct agency.

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- Compared hire dates and first dates of staff member assignment against clearance dates to determine whether a background clearance was completed prior to any direct interaction with students.
 - Obtained confirmation from each contractor's Custodian of Record certifying that assigned staff members had been fingerprinted and cleared prior to working at District school sites.⁴
 - Reviewed the submitted contractor certifications attesting that all required staff members had obtained DOJ clearance and had no disqualifying felony convictions.

Overall, testing confirmed that all 223 sampled contractor staff members had completed the required background checks.⁵ However, the OIG identified gaps in documentation, verification, and oversight that limited the District's ability to confirm compliance with fingerprinting and clearance requirements. Addressing these areas provides opportunities to strengthen the associated background-check processes.

Finding No. 1 - Out-of-State Contractor Non-Compliance with DOJ Fingerprint Clearance Requirements.

Criteria

The BSAP contract requires contractors to ensure that all employees and subcontractor personnel who may interact with students are fingerprinted through the DOJ process, and to provide written certification confirming that no disqualifying felony convictions exist. In addition, District Bulletin BUL-3872.2 clarifies that out-of-state contractors submit rolled fingerprint cards to the DOJ, as background checks conducted in other states do not satisfy the District's fingerprinting requirements.

Condition

Pretty Brown Girl, LLC (PBG), an out-of-state BSAP contractor based in Michigan, utilized a third-party provider to conduct national and state-level background checks in accordance with its internal policies. However, the contractor did not obtain DOJ fingerprint clearance for any of its staff members (facilitators) assigned to District sites. As a result, none of the contractor's facilitators delivering services to District students had DOJ fingerprint-based clearance, and PBG did not submit the required Certification Form to the District.

⁴ The Custodian of Record is the specific individual within an organization who is officially authorized by the DOJ to receive, secure, and manage Criminal Offender Record Information for that company.

⁵ Because of strict privacy restrictions regarding access to fingerprinting and criminal background check results, the OIG developed audit procedures designed to ensure we reviewed sufficient documentation to conclude that all 223 sampled staff members completed the required background check process. This documentation included Live Scan submission receipts, Applicant Tracking Identifier (ATI) numbers, and DOJ clearance notices.

Cause

PBG indicated that it was unaware of the District's DOJ fingerprinting requirement and believed its existing background check process met District expectations. The contractor indicated that it followed site-level instructions that did not reference DOJ clearance or certification requirements and was not informed of the District-wide requirement until October 2025, during this audit. PBG also reported limited familiarity with California's Live Scan fingerprinting process and the requirement for out-of-state contractors to submit rolled fingerprint cards to the DOJ.

Effect

The absence of DOJ fingerprint clearance for PBG facilitators limited the District's ability to confirm that the individuals providing services to students have met statutory, contractual, and District policy requirements. Because out-of-state contractors are required to submit rolled fingerprint cards to the DOJ, the lack of such clearance represents non-compliance with established screening requirements. Moreover, this condition weakens internal controls over contractor oversight and reduces the District's ability to demonstrate compliance during audits, investigations, or claims involving contractor personnel.

Recommendation No. 1

PBG should ensure that all staff members providing in-person or virtual services undergo background checks in accordance with the District's DOJ requirements and retain documentation of the results. PBG should also submit the required Certification Form to the District and implement internal controls, such as a compliance-tracking system, to ensure ongoing adherence to the District's requirements.

The BSAP contract sponsor should obtain DOJ clearance documentation, a completed Certification Form, and an updated staff roster for reconciliation against clearance records to verify PBG's compliance.

Response from Contractor

PBG acknowledged its intent to align its processes with District requirements. As of October 2025, PBG stated that it has implemented a written policy requiring all staff to complete the DOJ-mandated fingerprinting before providing services. PBG further stated it will begin submitting Certification Forms for applicable contracts and maintain electronic records of clearance documentation going forward.

Response from ETO

The BSAP contract sponsor will hold an in-person Vendor Information Session in Summer 2026 to review DOJ fingerprinting requirements, emphasize the need for rolled fingerprint cards for out-of-state vendors, reinforce Certification Form submission, staff roster maintenance, and document retention, and implement a standardized document submission process beginning in the 2026–27 school year.

Finding No. 2 - Late or Missing Submission of Required Certification Forms.

Criteria

Tutoring services, after-school programs, PFSS, and BSAP contracts require contractors to submit a written certification. This certification must confirm that all contractor staff members who may interact with students have successfully completed and cleared the required fingerprinting and background checks before beginning work with the District.

Condition

The OIG's review found that contractors' submissions of the required Certification Forms were inconsistent across programs. Of the 20 sampled contractors, 12 submitted Certification Forms; however, only 2 submitted the forms at or around contract execution. The remaining 10 submitted the forms only after the OIG's audit request, and 8 contractors did not submit any certification. The results are summarized below.

Contract/Program Category	Submission of Certifications		
	Timely Submission	Late Submission	Non-Submission
After-School Program	0	1	4
Tutoring Services	1	1	0
BSAP	1	8	0
PFSS	0	0	4
Total	2	10	8

Cause

The late or missing Certification Forms were primarily due to varying program practices, unclear expectations, and differing interpretations of contract requirements across contractors and District divisions.

- The after-school program contractors indicated that clearance information is entered into the BTB App—as directed by the contract sponsor—in lieu of submitting formal Certification Forms. This reflects a reliance on system-based tracking rather than on contractual documentation requirements.
- The PFSS contractors reported differing practices, including reliance on internal background checks, use of District systems (e.g., SharePoint), and/or lack of awareness of the requirement to submit Certification Forms. Some contractors explained that they had not been requested to submit such forms or that they believed their internal background clearance processes were sufficient.

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- The contractors for tutoring services stated they maintain and update a Google document that lists cleared staff and supporting documentation, but do not consistently submit Certification Forms, in some cases due to differing expectations across school sites or prior District practices.
 - The BSAP contractors cited reasons such as the lack of the Certification Form template inclusion in contract packages, the absence of District requests, and the belief that submission was only required if specifically requested by schools.

Effect

The inconsistent, delayed, or non-submission of Certification Forms reduces the District's ability to verify contractor compliance with fingerprinting and background check requirements and weakens oversight and documentation controls.

Recommendation No. 2

As the primary points of contact, the contract sponsors should strengthen controls to improve contractor compliance by establishing a standardized process that includes the following:

- Clearly communicate that submission of Certification Forms is mandatory under all applicable contracts, regardless of internal contractor tracking systems.
- Ensure the consistent receipt, tracking, and retention of Certification Forms.
- Update contract administration procedures to explicitly distinguish between internal tracking systems (e.g., the BTB App, SharePoint, Google documents) and required contractual documentation, ensuring that internal system entries do not replace formal certification unless contract language is formally revised.
- Provide targeted guidance to contractors clarifying submission requirements and timing expectations.
- Implement periodic monitoring procedures to verify that Certification Forms are submitted timely and maintained in accordance with contract requirements.

Response from ETO

The BSAP contract sponsor will use the Summer 2026 Vendor Information Session to clarify document submission deadlines and the possibility of placing purchase orders on hold for non-submission, and will implement a standardized document submission process for the 2026–27 school year.

Response from ODCE

The contract sponsor will require PFSS contractors to submit annual Certification Forms through a Google Form before services begin each school year, submit updated forms whenever staffing changes

occur, and will collaborate with the Procurement Services Division (PSD) to update contract language by September 2026 to reflect these requirements.

Response from BTB

BTB will formally notify all after-school program providers that Certification Forms must be submitted by July 31, and that this requirement applies to every contractor, regardless of their internal systems. To ensure consistency, BTB will establish standardized procedures for collecting, tracking, and storing these forms across all providers; furnish providers with an annual written schedule outlining all deadlines; implement a monthly tracking system to monitor which forms have been received and which remain outstanding; and conduct periodic monitoring to ensure that forms are timely, complete, and compliant with contract requirements.

Response from DOI

The tutoring services contract sponsor will send written notification to all tutoring vendors, reminding them that Certification Forms are due by July 31, 2026. The notification will emphasize that submitting these forms is mandatory for all contracts, regardless of any internal tracking systems used by the contractors. The contract sponsor will provide clear instructions, conduct regular reviews of submitted documentation, and establish follow-up procedures to address any missing or incomplete forms. Beginning on August 1, the contract sponsor will closely monitor submissions to ensure all required forms are submitted on time and that any discrepancies are resolved promptly.

Finding No. 3 - Incomplete Staff Clearance Information in the BTB App.

Criteria

The after-school program contract requires contractors to ensure that staff members who may have contact with students are fingerprinted and cleared through the DOJ prior to working at school sites, and to maintain an updated, site-specific list of all staff assigned to those sites.

Condition

In practice, BTB instructed contractors to enter staff Live Scan clearance dates into the BTB App to track clearance verification. To determine whether clearance information was properly recorded in the system, the OIG reviewed 97 staff members assigned to 10 school sites across 5 sampled after-school program contractors. The review identified the following:

- 52 of 97 staff members (54%) had clearance information recorded in the BTB App.
- 14 of 97 staff members (14%) had clearance information recorded in SharePoint instead of the BTB App.
- 26 of 97 staff members (27%) had no clearance information recorded in either system.

- 5 of 97 staff members (5%) had no clearance information recorded in either system because they were no longer employed by the contractors.

Clearance Submission Methods	Total Sampled Staff	% of Total Sampled Staff
Clearance information completed in the BTB App	52	54%
Clearance information uploaded to SharePoint	14	14%
Clearance information missing from the BTB App/SharePoint	26	27%
Staff no longer employed by the contractor	5	5%
Total	97	100%

Cause

Contractors cited various reasons for incomplete or missing entry of clearance information:

- Woodcraft Rangers stated that BTB App entry requirements were newly implemented, and historical clearance data initially uploaded to SharePoint had not yet fully migrated into the BTP App system.
- West Valley Boys and Girls Club reported technical issues within the BTB App that prevented clearance data from being properly displayed or recorded.
- Children, Youth & Family Collaborative indicated that staffing changes, limited system access, and a lack of standardized internal procedures contributed to incomplete or missing data entry for active staff.

Effect

The use of multiple tracking methods and incomplete entries in the BTB App undermines the system's effectiveness as a centralized record of contractor staff clearances. Consequently, compliance risk increases as the system cannot be used to confirm that all contractor personnel have completed the required fingerprinting and background checks.

Recommendation No. 3

If the BTB App is intended to serve as the primary tool for tracking contractor clearance, BTB should ensure that contract language and policy requirements align with this use. Additionally, BTB should strengthen oversight by implementing a formal monitoring process that includes: (a) clear instructions to contractors on required data entry procedures; (b) periodic reviews to identify missing or incomplete clearance records; and (c) follow-up procedures to ensure timely correction of discrepancies.

Response from Contractor

In response to OIG inquiries, the contractors provided updates and clarifications regarding the missing clearance information in the BTB App:

- Woodcraft Rangers stated they have entered all staff members into the system and are currently updating compliance records across program sites.
- West Valley Boys and Girls Club reported that missing records have been updated for current staff, and that any remaining gaps are related to staff members no longer employed or pending system access approval.
- Children, Youth & Family Collaborative reported implementing corrective actions, which include reconciling clearance records, updating BTB App entries, conducting staff member status audits, and establishing standardized procedures for real-time verification and ongoing compliance monitoring.

Response from BTB

BTB will create and distribute a comprehensive job aid that clearly outlines how contractors should enter staff clearance information into the BTB App, including details on required documentation and timelines. Additionally, BTB will conduct monthly reviews of contractor clearance records to identify any missing, incomplete, or expired information, and will provide contractors with compliance reports detailing clearance dates and status. SharePoint will continue to use conditional formatting to highlight any expiring or missing fingerprint records. BTB will also establish firm deadlines for contractors to address discrepancies and conduct follow-up checks to ensure that all updates are completed and staff remains compliant.

Objective 2: Assess whether District divisions have established and implemented adequate controls to ensure contractor compliance with fingerprinting and background check requirements.

To assess whether District divisions have established and implemented adequate controls to ensure contractor compliance with fingerprinting and background check requirements, the OIG reviewed the provisions of the sampled contracts and the prior bulletins referenced in those contracts. The OIG also met with contractors, contract sponsors, and District divisions to discuss how they have implemented and managed the requirements.

The District's fingerprinting and criminal background compliance bulletins have regularly evolved. From 2007 through 2025, various bulletin revisions have defined and refined the roles and responsibilities of contract sponsors, PSD, Risk Management (RM), and Human Resources (HR)/Employee Relations. Responsibilities have shifted as the District transitioned from a decentralized, paper-based process for managing fingerprinting and background check requirements to a more structured system with layered oversight and digital workflows. Currently, Bulletin BUL-3872.2 outlines the District responsibilities.

District Responsibilities	
Contract Sponsor (School/Office)	• Collect Certification Forms before services begin • Keep Certification Forms on file • Make sure only cleared staff come on campus • Confirm exemptions (if any) • Notify PSD when sole proprietors separate from the District
Procurement Services Division (PSD)	• Provide Certification Forms to contractors • Receive and upload completed forms to Ariba • Update vendor records when clearance changes • Notify HR when sole proprietors start or end contracts
Human Resources (HR)/Employee Relations	• Verify DOJ/FBI clearance for sole proprietors • Enter clearance results for sole proprietors into District systems • Notify District parties of clearance results or subsequent arrests for sole proprietors
Risk Management (RM)	• Consult on safety, exemptions, and subsequent arrest decisions • Maintain copies of Certification Forms

Bulletin BUL-3872.2 shows significant progress in defining roles and improving processes compared to earlier bulletins. However, the OIG has identified gaps in internal controls, implementation, and accountability, as highlighted in the findings below.

Finding No. 4 - Inconsistent Enforcement of Contractor Background Clearance Processes Across Contract Sponsors.

Criteria

According to current and prior District bulletins, the contract sponsor (defined as either the District school or central office department initiating the contract for services) is responsible for enforcing site-level access controls to prevent unauthorized individuals from working with students. This includes (1) obtaining and retaining Certification Forms prior to the start of services, and (2) ensuring that only individuals who have completed the DOJ background check and are listed on the Certification Forms are permitted to enter school sites or interact with students.

Condition

Across the four sampled program areas, contract sponsors demonstrated varying approaches to implementing the District's fingerprinting and background check requirements. While Bulletin BUL-3872.2 assigns contract sponsors responsibility for verifying contractor clearance, maintaining Certification Forms, and enforcing site-level access controls, implementation practices varied across contract sponsor departments.

Variations included the use of digital systems instead of Certification Forms, reliance on contractors to maintain clearance documentation, centralized tracking methods that were not accessible to school sites, and evolving practices intended to align with updated bulletin requirements. As a result, documentation practices and verification procedures differed significantly across programs, and the

ability to confirm that only cleared individuals were present at school sites was either inconsistent or nonexistent.

Cause

The inconsistencies arise primarily from different interpretations of District fingerprinting requirements and from the lack of a standardized, District-wide process that aligns with the current bulletin (i.e., Bulletin BUL-3872.2). Interviews with contract sponsors have highlighted the following contributing factors:

- BTB stated that clearance information is tracked through the BTB App for the after-school program, replacing the need for separate Certification Forms under its current process. BTB also acknowledged limited familiarity with the updated guidance in Bulletin BUL-3872.2 and noted that contract amendments have not been updated to reflect the revised requirements.
- ODCE reported that Certification Forms were not routinely collected for review, and that the office historically relied on contractors to update clearance information under PFSS contracts; ODCE is now working to align its practices with current bulletin requirements.
- DOI relies on contractor-submitted spreadsheets to track tutor clearance status; these spreadsheets are maintained centrally and not accessible to school sites, thereby limiting independent verification. DOI also noted instances in which vendors attempted to engage with schools without providing the required clearance documentation.
- ETO only recently began collecting fingerprinting documentation for BSAP contracts in 2025–26; ETO previously assumed that PSD was solely responsible for verification.

Effect

Inconsistent implementation of District fingerprinting policies increases the risk that individuals without required background checks may access school sites or interact with students.

Recommendation No. 4

Contract sponsor departments should strengthen oversight and ensure consistent implementation of Bulletin BUL-3872.2 by standardizing fingerprinting requirements and Certification Form expectations to:

- Provide formal training and written guidance to contract sponsor staff to ensure a clearer understanding of roles and responsibilities.
- Create a standardized, centralized system for the tracking and retention of clearance documentation submitted by contractors and sole proprietors, and make it accessible to relevant District stakeholders.
- Establish monitoring and accountability mechanisms to ensure Certification Forms are collected, reviewed, and retained prior to the start of services.

Response from ETO

The BSAP contract sponsor will address document submission deadlines, potential purchase order holds, staff roster maintenance, and school-site responsibilities—including vendor sign-in procedures, roster verification, and Ariba upload duties—during the Summer 2026 Vendor Information Session, and will implement a standardized document submission process in 2026–27.

Response from ODCE

The contract sponsor will update the PFSS Handbook by August 2026 to require submission of Certification Forms and timely staffing updates, post the PFSS Handbook and guidance publicly, and work with other divisions to develop a vendor and school training video by August 2026.

Response from BTB

BTB will provide written guidance, job aids, and procedures to clarify expectations for clearance documentation, submission of Certification Forms, and compliance timelines; review these requirements during the annual provider start-up meeting held before each school year; and continue to use centralized tracking systems, including SharePoint and the BTB App, to monitor clearance dates, submission status, and any missing or expired records. While the BTB App assists with monitoring, it does not replace the need for Certification Forms. BTB will maintain ongoing monitoring and accountability measures, including deadline reminders, monthly compliance tracking, periodic record reviews, and follow-up actions to address any incomplete documentation.

Response from DOI

The tutoring services contract sponsor will strengthen oversight by ensuring Certification Forms are consistently collected, reviewed, and retained before services begin; establish formal communication protocols with PSD, HR, RM, and other District offices to improve the flow of clearance information; support the development of a centralized, standardized system for storing Certification Forms and fingerprint documentation; provide formal training and written guidance to contract sponsor staff to clarify roles and responsibilities under Bulletin BUL-3872.2; and implement monitoring services to ensure timely submission, and periodic compliance reviews beginning in October 2026.

Finding No. 5 – Lack of Coordination and Documentation Controls Over Contractor Clearance Processes Across District Divisions.

Criteria

Bulletin BUL-3872.2 and its previous versions outline specific responsibilities for PSD, RM, and HR regarding the obtaining, processing, storing, and sharing of Certification Forms. These responsibilities include ensuring the proper collection, retention, and distribution of Certification Forms, as well as the appropriate documentation of fingerprint clearance records. Bulletin BUL-3872.2 emphasizes the need for coordinated management of clearance information across divisions, reflecting the evolution of District procedures and workflows.

Condition

Although Bulletin BUL-3872.2 clarified and expanded District division responsibilities, the sampled contracts were executed under earlier versions of the bulletin in effect at the time of execution. Based on the sampled contracts, the OIG identified oversight and documentation gaps across the responsible divisions under previous bulletin requirements, as highlighted below:

- For the sampled contracts executed under prior Bulletin BUL-3872.0, RM was responsible for receiving and maintaining the Certification Forms. However, RM was unable to locate Certification Forms for 16 sampled contractors, and clearance documentation for 7 BSAP sole proprietor contracts executed during the same period.
- The implementation of responsibilities related to sole proprietor clearance was inconsistent between PSD and HR. Although prior Bulletin BUL-3872.1 established clear requirements for HR to process fingerprinting, maintain the results, and notify the relevant parties, these responsibilities did not apply retroactively to previously executed sole proprietor contracts. As a result, clearance documentation for 5 out of 7 sampled sole proprietors was unavailable from HR. Furthermore, the OIG's follow-up with PSD revealed that they also did not keep any corresponding records for the sole proprietors in question.
- A lack of coordinated action across divisions following the issuance of updated guidance led to incomplete or missing clearance documentation. This limits the District's ability to demonstrate full compliance for contracts executed under earlier bulletins and increases the risk that current practices do not fully align with updated requirements.

Cause

Interviews with District divisions revealed inconsistent processes and unclear role expectations across the responsible offices. These factors hindered coordination, highlighted ambiguous accountability for historical contracts, and reflected the lack of a unified tracking system across divisions.

- RM indicated its previous role was limited to receiving and physically filing Certification Forms without a centralized tracking system, database, or follow-up mechanism. RM described its current function as administrative rather than oversight-focused.
- PSD reported uncertainty regarding the timing and responsibility for coordinating sole proprietor fingerprinting with HR, noting that at certain points, HR was not processing such requests. This resulted in PSD directing sole proprietors to complete their own fingerprinting.
- HR confirmed it did not maintain clearance records for 5 of the 7 sampled sole proprietors and stated that a complete list of individuals requiring fingerprinting was not provided when earlier bulletin versions were issued. Under current procedures, HR receives notifications from PSD and processes fingerprinting requests through the DOJ portal.

Effect

The lack of coordination, documentation retention, and information sharing among District divisions increases the risk that required documentation may be incomplete or unavailable, thereby hindering compliance with District policies.

Recommendation No. 5

The District should improve coordination, accountability, and documentation controls among the PSD, HR, and RM divisions to ensure consistent adherence to fingerprinting and clearance requirements as outlined in the current bulletin guidance. To prevent the issues that arose under previous bulletins, the District should implement the following measures:

- Establish formalized communication and coordination protocols among PSD, HR, and RM to improve timely notification, processing, and sharing of contractor clearance information, including sole proprietor fingerprinting requirements.
- Implement a centralized and standardized tracking and record-retention system for Certification Forms and fingerprint clearance documentation that is accessible to all responsible divisions to support verification and oversight.
- Clarify and document division-specific responsibilities under Bulletin BUL-3872.2, including how division roles apply to both current contracts and legacy contracts executed under prior bulletin versions, to ensure consistent interpretation and implementation.
- Conduct a reconciliation review of existing contractor and sole proprietor records to identify and address missing or incomplete clearance documentation where feasible.

Response from PSD

PSD agreed with the OIG's recommendation and stated that it is already coordinating with HR and RM to implement the procedures outlined in Bulletin BUL-3872.2. PSD will continue to issue and collect Certification Forms, upload them to Ariba, and provide copies to the contract sponsors. It will also work with HR, RM, and School Operations to explore a centralized tracking and record-retention system accessible to contract sponsors. Because PSD is coordinating implementation with HR and RM, its response reflects the District's overall actions to address this recommendation.

Response from HR

HR stated that the Human Relations office within their division will continue entering sole-proprietor fingerprint results into the District's central repository. HR added that PSD and RM will assign staff to review and monitor these results, and that coordination work has already begun. PSD has met with Employee Relations to align on the process, and both the designation of responsible staff and training are currently underway.

Response from RM

RM agreed with the audit recommendation and will collaborate with HR and PSD to clearly define its role in the fingerprinting process and improve coordination across divisions. Specifically, the department will continue to store and file the Certification Forms, establish a tracking system, and work with HR and PSD to develop a centralized records retention process that enables contract sponsors to access, verify, and manage contractor clearance results.

Finding No. 6 - Inadequate Controls Over Contractor Staff Clearance Updates.

Criteria

Bulletin BUL-3872.2 requires contractors to complete, maintain, and update Certification Forms and to resubmit updated staff member clearance information when personnel changes occur. Contract sponsors—as the designated recipients of these updates—are responsible for administering and ensuring that contractors comply with these requirements.

Condition

To identify any instances in which individuals were actively working at school sites but were not reflected on District-maintained rosters or Certification Forms, the OIG obtained current personnel rosters or Certification Forms from the sampled contractors and compared them with the District's existing staff clearance records or Certification Forms.

The OIG identified discrepancies in 3 of 9 sampled BSAP contracts and 3 of 4 sampled PFSS contracts. In these cases, contractors maintained updated internal rosters that accurately reflected current staff member assignments; however, the updated information was not submitted to the District.

Additionally, the BSAP, PFSS, and tutoring contracts do not require contractors to submit updated staff rosters or notify the District of personnel changes. Of the 20 contracts reviewed, only after-school program contracts included such a provision.

Cause

The OIG identified two primary factors that contributed to the lack of submission, retention, and verification of updated contractor staff clearance information.

1. Standard BSAP, PFSS, and tutoring contract templates do not require contractors to submit updated staff clearance rosters or notify the District of personnel changes. While Bulletin BUL-3872.2 requires contractors to maintain and update Certification Forms, this requirement is not reflected in the contract language for all contracts the OIG reviewed, resulting in a misalignment between policy expectations and contractual obligations.
2. Interviews indicated varying practices regarding roster submission and monitoring:

-
- ETO indicated that BSAP contractors are expected to notify the District of staffing and clearance changes, and that the Custodians of Record are responsible for reporting significant updates. However, submission of updated rosters was not enforced, and school sites did not always retain records to verify contractor staff member assignments.
 - ODCE indicated that its role is limited to coordination and that it does not collect or maintain PFSS staff rosters or Certification Forms. According to ODCE, there was no previously established process for sharing updated roster information across District entities; contractors are expected to provide updates directly to contract sponsors, schools, and PSD.

Effect

The use of outdated or incomplete contractor staff clearance information increases the risk that individuals with unverified clearance status may gain unauthorized access to schools and students.

Recommendation No. 6

The contract sponsors should strengthen controls to ensure that contractor staff clearance information remains current and complete by:

- Establishing a standardized process for the submission, review, and retention of updated contractor staff clearance rosters when personnel changes occur, including defined submission frequency, required format, and responsible parties for receipt and verification.
- Implementing procedures to validate that updated staff rosters and Certification Forms accurately correspond to cleared individuals providing services to the District.

PSD should revise future BSAP, PFSS, and tutoring contract templates to explicitly require contractors to submit updated staff clearance rosters and revisions to the Certification Form in accordance with Bulletin BUL-3872.2. Incorporating these requirements into contracts will align contractual obligations with District policy and strengthen enforcement.

Response from ETO

The BSAP contract sponsor will highlight the requirement that school sites designate a custodian and submit updated vendor staff rosters monthly through the standardized submission process during the Summer 2026 Vendor Information Session.

Response from ODCE

The contract sponsor will require PFSS contractors to submit Certification Forms through a Google Form by the end of July 2026 to ensure all forms are received before the school year begins, and will collaborate with other divisions to develop a training video for vendors and schools by August 2026.

Response from PSD

PSD agreed with the OIG's recommendation and will update BSAP, PFSS, and tutoring contract templates to require contractors to submit revised Certification Forms when personnel changes occur. PSD will issue amendments to existing BSAP and PFSS contracts and will provide contract sponsors with copies of the revised forms upon receipt.

Finding No. 7 – Inconsistent Contractor Fingerprinting and Background Check Requirements Across Contract Templates.

Criteria

District fingerprinting bulletins establish uniform requirements for contractor clearance, notably enrollment in the DOJ's subsequent-arrest notification system, receipt of ongoing criminal-history updates, and timely reporting of any subsequent arrests or convictions to the District. The Certification Forms further require contractors to report such updates within 24 hours of being notified by the DOJ, as explicitly indicated on the form.

Condition

The OIG found that the District's contractor fingerprinting and background requirements were not reflected across the four contract types reviewed. While all contracts included general provisions on initial clearance and the removal of disqualified contractor personnel, they differed in how they addressed documentation requirements and ongoing monitoring obligations. Key inconsistencies include:

- BSAP contracts require written certification of DOJ clearance and immediate removal of employees with certain criminal convictions; however, these contracts do not include requirements for enrollment in DOJ subsequent arrest notifications or reporting of subsequent arrests or convictions within 24 hours.
- PFSS and tutoring contracts require written certification of clearance, but do not include the District's Certification Form template or instructions for obtaining it. These contracts do not mention enrollment in DOJ subsequent-arrest notifications or the timely reporting of subsequent arrests or convictions.
- After-school program contracts reference the Certification Form but do not include the form or instructions for accessing it. In practice, contractors were directed to use the BTB App system instead of the contract-required form. These contracts also do not include requirements for DOJ subsequent arrest notifications or reporting obligations.

Across all contract types, none explicitly requires contractors to enroll in DOJ's subsequent-arrest notifications, receive ongoing updates, or report subsequent arrests or convictions within 24 hours. As a result, contract templates do not fully reflect District requirements for ongoing monitoring of contractor personnel after initial clearance.

Cause

The language related to fingerprinting and background checks varies across contract programs due to differences in template development and program-specific modifications. In addition, revisions to District fingerprinting bulletins have contributed to misalignment between current policy requirements and existing contract language, as updates have not been consistently incorporated into all contract templates or uniformly applied across program revisions.

Effect

Use of inconsistent contract language may result in conflicting instructions and unclear compliance expectations. In addition, the omission of the DOJ's subsequent arrest notification requirements limits the District's ability to ensure continuous monitoring of contractor personnel after initial clearance, thereby reducing its ability to identify individuals who become ineligible and increasing compliance and student safety risks.

Recommendation No. 7

PSD should standardize fingerprinting and background check language across all future contract templates to ensure full alignment with Bulletin BUL-3872.2 and any program-related policies. Standardizing the required provisions (while allowing program-specific operational adjustments where necessary) promotes consistent implementation, strengthens oversight, and improves the District's ability to demonstrate compliance with applicable laws and internal policies.

Based on the conditions or recommendations noted in Finding Nos. 1, 3, and 6, PSD should also incorporate the following contract provisions to clarify requirements applicable to specific contract or program categories:

- Background clearance requirements for out-of-state contractors, including acceptable documentation and verification standards.
- Options and guidance for alternative system-based certification, such as the use of the BTB App for validating clearance.
- Mandatory submission of updated staff rosters and Certification Forms to reflect any changes in contractor personnel to prevent lapses in current and accurate clearance information.

Response from PSD

PSD agreed with the OIG's recommendation and will standardize fingerprinting and background-check language across all future contract templates to align with Bulletin BUL-3872.2. This includes requirements for out-of-state contractors, alternative system-based certifications (e.g., BTB App), and mandatory submission of updated staff rosters and Certification Forms.

Objective 3: Evaluate whether schools have implemented effective procedures to ensure that only cleared contractor staff provide services on campus.

Schools are required to verify contractor clearance documentation, enforce identification and check-in procedures, maintain accurate records of approved personnel, and monitor contractor activities to ensure compliance with District safety requirements and contractual service provisions.

To evaluate implementation of these procedures across District schools, the OIG (1) distributed a questionnaire to administrators at 36 schools to obtain information on site practices for verifying contractor clearance, maintaining approved staff lists, and managing daily check-in procedures; and (2) conducted site visits at 32 of the 36 schools to review relevant documentation, including Certification Forms, staff rosters, and sign-in logs.

During the site visits, the OIG also interviewed contractor staff members to assess compliance with daily check-in requirements, including whether staff signed in upon arrival, presented required identification, and displayed any applicable program-specific identifiers, such as uniforms.

Finding No. 8 – Inconsistent Contractor Clearance Verification Practices Across School Sites.

Criteria

At the school site level, District fingerprinting bulletin requirements and related guidance from the Division of School Operations require schools to:

- Obtain completed Certification Forms prior to the start of contractor services and maintain these records on site.
- Ensure that only contractor personnel who have completed the required DOJ background check and are listed on Certification Forms or approved rosters are permitted to enter campuses or interact with students, including during virtual services.
- Monitor contractor staff member presence and activities to ensure compliance with District safety procedures and contract requirements.

In addition, school administrators are expected to:

- Maintain current records of approved contractor personnel.
- Enforce identification and check-in procedures, including photo ID verification and use of contractor badges.
- Maintain contractor-specific sign-in logs separate from general visitor logs.
- Ensure timely communication of contractor staffing changes to allow verification of clearance prior to new personnel reporting to the site.

Condition

Responses to the OIG’s questionnaire from 36 school administrators, reflecting their understanding of the role and responsibility for contractor clearance procedures, varied across school sites:

- 21 of 36 schools (58%) relied on District-level processes and assumed contractor personnel were cleared prior to arrival.
- 10 of 36 schools (28%) relied on contractors to ensure clearance without independently verifying documentation.
- 5 of 36 schools (14%) verified clearance by checking whether contractor names appeared on submitted Certification Forms or rosters.

School-Reported Approaches to Contractor Clearance Responsibilities	Total Responses	% of Total Responses
District-Assumed Clearance – Schools relied on District processes and assumed contractor staff was already cleared.	21	58%
Contractor-Assumed Clearance – Schools relied on contractors to ensure staff was cleared without independent verification.	10	28%
Name Check Verification – Schools verified staff clearance by checking whether staff names appeared on submitted forms.	5	14%
Total Responses	36	100%

Additionally, site visits to 32 of the 36 sampled schools identified the following gaps in internal controls:

No.	Observations Noted During School Visits
1	Certification Forms were not maintained at 26 of 32 schools (81%).
2	Approved contractor staff lists were not maintained at 15 of 32 schools (47%).
3	Contractor-specific sign-in logs were not maintained at 17 of 32 schools (53%).
4	Photo identification was not required at 10 of 32 schools (31%).
5	Updated contractor staff lists were not maintained at 2 of 32 schools (6%)

Cause

Based on school administrators’ feedback and site-visit observations (see Exhibit B for the full list of site visits and comments), the OIG identified several factors contributing to gaps in controls and conflicting understandings and practices.

-
- Limited awareness of specific responsibilities under District fingerprinting requirements, with administrators requesting clearer guidance and training.
 - Reliance on contractors or District divisions for clearance verification, resulting in reduced independent validation at the school level.
 - Delayed or incomplete communication of staffing changes from contractors and District divisions, affecting the accuracy of site-level records.
 - Absence of a centralized District system to verify contractor clearance status in real time, limiting schools' ability to independently confirm eligibility.
 - Lack of standardized tools and procedures, such as digital rosters, consistent ID verification protocols, and uniform sign-in systems.

Effect

The lack of contractor clearance controls at the school site level creates gaps in verification and increases the risk of unauthorized contractor staff members on school campuses or interactions with students.⁶

Recommendation No. 8

The contract sponsors, in collaboration with school-site staff, should improve contractor clearance verification controls at the school level and ensure compliance with Bulletin BUL-3872.2 and the directives from the Division of School Operations by:

- Creating a centralized system for school sites to access and independently verify real-time contractor clearance status.
- Standardizing access control procedures by requiring photo identification checks and specific sign-in logs for contractors at all school sites.
- Enhancing communication protocols for prompt notification of staffing changes and updated staff rosters before contractor personnel arrive at campuses.
- Providing ongoing targeted training for school-site staff to reinforce clearance requirements, verification procedures, and responsibilities under District policy.

⁶ During this audit, the OIG was informed by the District Attorney's Office of the arrest of an after-school program contractor staff member. This contractor was not included in the sample selected for detailed testing; however, the District contract sponsor for that contractor was included. The OIG notified the District contract sponsor, which indicated the District does not receive notification when a contract professional is arrested. After being alerted, the contract sponsor contacted the contractor the same day to ensure the employee no longer had access to District sites. The OIG confirmed with the contractor that the employee's access was removed. According to the contractor, it became aware of the arrest through the contract sponsor and took immediate action. Although this incident was outside the scope of our audit, we include it here for context.

Response from ETO

The BSAP contract sponsor will instruct school sites during the Summer 2026 Vendor Information Session to maintain on-site Certification Form documentation and implement a vendor check-in system that includes sign-in sheets, photo ID checks, and roster verification.

Response from ODCE

Beginning in the 2026–27 school year, the contract sponsor will provide schools with a shared folder containing all Certification Forms and an updated PFSS Handbook, make recorded training available to schools and vendors, and verify vendor staff rosters during service observation visits by cross-referencing sign-in logs with Certification Forms to monitor compliance.

Response from BTB

BTB will require contractors to submit certified staff rosters monthly, listing all cleared personnel assigned to each school site; review and compile these rosters and distribute updated versions to school administrators to facilitate accurate site-level verification; continue to conduct monthly site visits to check sign-in records, verify rosters, and observe program operations, ensuring that only approved staff are present and wearing identifiable attire; and provide regular updates on contractor staffing and clearance documentation to ensure schools always have the most current information for verification.

Response from DOI

The tutoring services contract sponsor will reinforce school-site access controls by supporting photo ID checks and standardized contractor sign-in logs at all participating schools; improve communication protocols to ensure schools receive timely staffing updates and updated rosters before personnel begin services; provide schools with monthly lists of approved tutoring personnel; and work closely with contractors to ensure roster information remains accurate and up to date. The contract sponsor noted that ongoing monitoring will help ensure staffing changes are communicated promptly and that only cleared individuals are allowed on campus.

AUDIT TEAM

The following auditors performed this audit:

Stella Lai, Audit Manager
Joanna Vuong, Principal Auditor
Derek Kim, Senior Auditor

SCOPE AND OBJECTIVES

The objectives of this audit were to: (1) determine whether contractors complied with the CA Ed. Code, District policies and procedures, and contract requirements for fingerprinting and criminal background checks; (2) assess whether District divisions have established and implemented adequate controls to ensure contractor compliance with fingerprinting and background check requirements; and (3) evaluate whether schools have implemented effective procedures to ensure that only cleared contractor staff provide services on campus.

We conducted our audit in accordance with *Generally Accepted Government Auditing Standards* (GAGAS). Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain sufficient, appropriate evidence to provide a reasonable basis for our findings and conclusions based on our audit objectives. We believe that the evidence obtained provides a reasonable basis for our findings and conclusions on our audit objectives. The audit covered contracts that were awarded to selected contractors between June 22, 2022, and June 30, 2029.

METHODOLOGY

To accomplish our audit objectives, the audit team performed a range of procedures, including but not limited to: (i) reviewing contract terms and conditions, District policies and procedures, and applicable CA Ed. Code requirements related to contractor fingerprinting and background checks; (ii) administering questionnaires to contractors, contract sponsors, and school administrators to understand the internal controls currently in place to verify and ensure compliance with background-check requirements; (iii) examining documentation to confirm that contractor-certified staff completed required background checks prior to the start of work; (iv) interviewing District divisions and reviewing internal records to assess whether staff complied with the District's fingerprinting and background-check bulletins; and (v) conducting site visits to observe the protocols used to verify contractor staff on District campuses.

EVALUATION OF INTERNAL CONTROLS

In accordance with *Government Auditing Standards*, the OIG obtained an understanding of internal controls that are significant within the context of the audit objectives. We assessed whether internal controls were properly designed and implemented. For the controls deemed significant, we obtained sufficient and appropriate evidence to support our assessment of their effectiveness.

We are required to report deficiencies in internal controls that are significant within the context of the audit objectives. A deficiency in internal controls exists when the design or operation of a control does not allow management or employees, in the normal course of performing their assigned functions, to prevent, or detect and correct (i) impairments of effectiveness or efficiency of operations, (ii) misstatements in financial or performance information, or (iii) non-compliance with provisions, laws, regulations, contracts, or grant agreements on a timely basis. Based on our audit, we did not find significant deficiencies in internal controls. However, we found that internal controls could be strengthened, as detailed in the Results of Audit section of this report.

LIST OF CONTRACTORS SELECTED FOR TESTING

Sample Number	Contractor	Contract/Program Category	Ariba Contract ID	Contract - Effective Date	Contract - Expiration Date	Contract - Maximum Limit	Amount Used as of 6/30/2025	Contract Sponsor
1	Woodcraft Rangers	After-School Program	C897	6/21/2024	6/30/2027	\$ 22,550,000	\$ 20,743,737	Beyond the Bell
2	Boys & Girls Club of the West Valley	After-School Program	C887	6/21/2024	6/30/2027	\$ 4,000,000	\$ 3,565,912	Beyond the Bell
3	YMCA of Metropolitan Los Angeles	After-School Program	C455	6/21/2024	6/30/2027	\$ 3,900,000	\$ 2,332,218	Beyond the Bell
4	Children, Youth & Family Collaborative	After-School Program	C1598	6/21/2024	6/30/2027	\$ 1,100,000	\$ 1,009,105	Beyond the Bell
5	Gang Alternative Program	After-School Program	C891	6/21/2024	6/30/2027	\$ 1,170,000	\$ 986,122	Beyond the Bell
6	Study Smart Tutors, Inc.	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	C168	11/7/2023	6/30/2026	\$ 14,742,312	\$ 7,665,613	Educational Transformation Office
7	Community-Based Public Safety College	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	C1294	7/1/2023	4/30/2026	\$ 1,271,000	\$ 730,412	Educational Transformation Office
8	GWAP Consulting, LLC dba Stemnetics	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	C7685	9/23/2024	4/30/2026	\$ 300,000	\$ 3,375	Educational Transformation Office
9	Music Notes, LLC	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	C7649	10/3/2024	4/30/2026	\$ 300,000	\$ 27,000	Educational Transformation Office
10	Pretty Brown Girl, LLC	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	C7587	10/1/2024	4/30/2026	\$ 300,000	\$ 77,990	Educational Transformation Office
11	New Hope Academy of Change	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	C1290	7/1/2023	4/30/2026	\$ 1,271,000	\$ 1,154,800	Educational Transformation Office

LIST OF CONTRACTORS SELECTED FOR TESTING

Sample Number	Contractor	Contract/Program Category	Ariba Contract ID	Contract - Effective Date	Contract - Expiration Date	Contract - Maximum Limit	Amount Used as of 6/30/2025	Contract Sponsor
12	School Yard Rap, LLC	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	C7683	10/14/2024	4/30/2026	\$ 300,000	\$ 195,599	Educational Transformation Office
13	Strong Shoulders Agency	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	C3207	8/7/2024	4/30/2026	\$ 1,100,000	\$ 1,032,955	Educational Transformation Office
14	Glad Academics, LLC	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	C7582	9/19/2024	4/30/2026	\$ 300,000	\$ 288,000	Educational Transformation Office
15	Educare Foundation	Partners For Student Success (PFSS)	C7465	1/15/2025	1/14/2030	\$ 792,534	\$ 792,533	Office of Development & Civic Engagement
16	City Year, Inc.	Partners For Student Success (PFSS)	C7459	1/15/2025	1/14/2030	\$ 387,019	\$ 387,019	Office of Development & Civic Engagement
17	Los Angeles Education Partnership	Partners For Student Success (PFSS)	C7470	1/15/2025	1/14/2030	\$ 221,001	\$ 221,000	Office of Development & Civic Engagement
18	Partnership for Los Angeles Schools	Partners For Student Success (PFSS)	C7473	1/15/2025	1/14/2030	\$ 40,001	\$ 40,000	Office of Development & Civic Engagement
19	The Southern California Learning Corp., dba Sylvan Learning Centers	Tutoring Services	C2886	6/22/2022	6/21/2027	\$ 22,693,750	\$ 3,516,750	Division of Instruction
20	Cognition, Inc.	Tutoring Services	C1217	6/23/2022	6/21/2027	\$ 9,269,040	\$ 221,352	Division of Instruction
Total						\$ 86,007,657	\$ 44,991,492	

SITE VISITS & FEEDBACK FROM SCHOOL ADMINISTRATORS

Sample Number	School	Contractor	Contract/Program Category	Principal Feedback/Suggestions
1	Alexander ES	Woodcraft Rangers	After-School Program	Maintain a live Excel spreadsheet supported by the after-school contractor and Beyond the Bell and shared with the school principal, assistant principals, and office manager.
2	West Adams HS	Woodcraft Rangers	After-School Program	A centralized District system listing of cleared contractor staff would improve monitoring and compliance.
3	Mosk ES	Boys & Girls Club of the West Valley	After-School Program	We were unaware of our responsibilities regarding fingerprinting requirements, but we are eager to learn best practices for compliance. We need a clear system to follow, training, and improved communication.
4	Reseda ES	Boys & Girls Club of the West Valley	After-School Program	A visitor management system could be used by visitors, with access for the coordinator, the school administrative assistant, and the administrator.
5	32nd Street School/USC Magnet	YMCA of Metro LA	After-School Program	None.
6	Northridge Academy HS	YMCA of Metro LA	After-School Program	None.
7	Crenshaw HS	Children, Youth & Family Collaborative	After-School Program	Challenges include a lack of documentation, the absence of a centralized list, and reliance on vendor-managed logs. A centralized district system for cleared staff lists is needed, along with mandatory main-office check-ins and improved vendor communication.
8	Dorsey HS	Children, Youth & Family Collaborative	After-School Program	We only receive confirmation from vendors that the background clearance process is completed.
9	Catskill Ave ES	Gang Alternative Program	After-School Program	There is documentation showing that each individual in the After-School Program has passed their clearance. During this audit, the school established a distinct sign-in log specifically for the after-school program.
10	232nd ES	Gang Alternative Program	After-School Program	Annual communication, including staff and student rosters for the program.
11	Ramona ES	Study Smart Tutors	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	Vendor staff may share clearance documents with the school site.

SITE VISITS & FEEDBACK FROM SCHOOL ADMINISTRATORS

Sample Number	School	Contractor	Contract/Program Category	Principal Feedback/Suggestions
12	RFK New Open World Academy	Study Smart Tutors	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	We do not have the information or access necessary to verify staff clearance.
13	Los Angeles HS	Community-Based Public Safety College	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	Regular communication with the Supervisor for Safe Passage and the school is essential.
14	Jefferson HS	Community-Based Public Safety College	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	The procedures for contractors should align with those for athletic coaches to ensure staff follow similar clearance processes.
15	Amestoy ES – <i>no vendor staff were scheduled</i>	Stemnetics	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	We cannot proceed without the Purchase Order; it must be completed first and approved through procurement.
16	156th ES – <i>no vendor staff were scheduled</i>	Stemnetics	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	A database will be created to maintain a list of cleared vendors and all staff members. The school should be able to look up a vendor's name and verify the employees associated with that vendor against the cleared list. This will ensure that no one is added to the list without proper clearance.
17	Ambler ES	Music Notes, LLC	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	A comprehensive database provided by the District to cross-check contractor submissions for their clearance.
18	Compton Ave ES	Music Notes, LLC	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	Effective communication is essential due to staff changes; a centralized District tracking system and timely updates are necessary for site-level oversight.
19	LA Center for Enriched Studies	Pretty Brown Girl	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	The District has confirmed that contractor staff have been vetted and cleared before being made available to schools.
20	Nobel Charter MS	Pretty Brown Girl	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	None.

SITE VISITS & FEEDBACK FROM SCHOOL ADMINISTRATORS

Sample Number	School	Contractor	Contract/Program Category	Principal Feedback/Suggestions
21	Western Ave Tech ES	New Hope Academy of Change	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	We voluntarily verify vendor staff on the Megan's Law website and create a centralized database that allows schools to confirm vendor staff clearance, including employee photographs for identification purposes.
22	Winsor Hills ES	New Hope Academy of Change	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	Every vendor should have employee ID badges displaying their organization's name.
23	Woodland Hills Academy	School Yard Rap	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	This task was previously unknown to me. We confirm that the contractor is cleared, but we do not verify which employees they hire.
24	Bancroft MS	School Yard Rap	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	Contractor staff should wear District-issued badges or provide photos of cleared staff members arriving at the school.
25	Audubon MS	Strong Shoulders Agency	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	None.
26	Hawkins HS	Strong Shoulders Agency	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	Logistics are managed by the District. If the school receives no updates from the BSAP office, the school will assume everything is clear. Please ensure that the school receives information in a timely manner.
27	Amestoy ES – <i>no campus tours were scheduled</i>	Glad Academics	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	None.
28	Hamilton HS – <i>no campus tours were scheduled</i>	Glad Academics	Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP)	The contractor's participation in the service during off-hours, such as evenings or weekends, may create challenges for signing in at the main office. Receiving a central notification that includes a list of vendors would greatly assist us in managing oversight.
29	107th Street ES	Educare Foundation	Partners For Student Success (PFSS)	None.
30	San Fernando HS	Educare Foundation	Partners For Student Success (PFSS)	Using high-visibility badges that display the District's markings would simplify this process.

SITE VISITS & FEEDBACK FROM SCHOOL ADMINISTRATORS

Sample Number	School	Contractor	Contract/Program Category	Principal Feedback/Suggestions
31	Manual Arts HS	City Year, Inc.	Partners For Student Success (PFSS)	None.
32	Normandie Ave ES	City Year, Inc.	Partners For Student Success (PFSS)	Provide clear instructions on the required documentation for contractor personnel and ensure proper verification of their clearances before they arrive on campus.
33	122nd Street ES	Los Angeles Education Partnership	Partners For Student Success (PFSS)	It is challenging to obtain information from the respective office; an online management system from the district is essential.
34	75th Street ES	Los Angeles Education Partnership	Partners For Student Success (PFSS)	One challenge is keeping up with updated lists; we could receive support by having the contractor staff vetted by the District.
35	Roosevelt HS – <i>staff clearance by LAUSD HR</i>	Partnership for Los Angeles Schools	Partners For Student Success (PFSS)	None.
36	Mendez HS – <i>staff clearance by LAUSD HR</i>	Partnership for Los Angeles Schools	Partners For Student Success (PFSS)	None.
37	Harbor City ES	Sylvan Learning Centers	Tutoring Services	A digital device for entering names, dates, and reasons for visits, allowing for centralized tracking of visitors.
38	Mark Twain MS	Sylvan Learning Centers	Tutoring Services	Currently, schools lack access to the information needed to monitor contractor compliance. A real-time updated list of approved tutors provided by the District should be accessible to all schools.
39	<i>N/A – Online</i>	Cognition, Inc.	Tutoring Services	None.
40	<i>N/A – Online</i>	Cognition, Inc.	Tutoring Services	None.

RESPONSE FROM ETO

INTER-OFFICE CORRESPONDENCE
LOS ANGELES UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT

TO: Mark H. Pearson, Assistant Inspector General
Office of the Inspector General **Date:** June 8, 2026

FROM: Dr. Travis Brandy, Senior Director
Educational Transformation Office *TB*

**SUBJECT: RESPONSE TO PERFORMANCE AUDIT OF CONTRACTOR
FINGERPRINTING COMPLIANCE – BSAP RESPONSE TO FINDINGS:
1,2,4,6, AND 8**

Recommendation No. 1: Page 6

PBG should ensure that all staff members providing in-person or virtual services undergo background checks in accordance with the District's DOJ requirements and retain documentation of the results. PBG should also submit the required Certification Form to the District and implement internal controls, such as a compliance tracking system, to ensure ongoing adherence to District requirements.

Finding #1: Out-of-State Contractor Non-Compliance with DOJ Fingerprint Clearance Requirements

- A Vendor Information Session will be held in-person for all active contracted vendors to review the Fingerprinting requirements for both in-state and out-of-state vendors. (Summer 2026)
- Specifically highlighting:
 - The submission of rolled fingerprint cards to the DOJ for out-of-state vendors
 - Completion and submission of District Certification Forms
 - Maintaining a current staff roster
 - The importance of document retention
- Creation of BSAP, a standardized document submission process, will be implemented for the 26/27 SY (Summer 2026)

Recommendation No. 2: Page 8

As the primary points of contact, the contract sponsors should strengthen controls to improve contractor compliance by establishing a standardized process that includes the following:

- Clearly communicate that submission of Certification Forms is mandatory under all applicable contracts, regardless of internal contractor tracking systems.

RESPONSE FROM ETO

- Ensure the consistent receipt, tracking, and retention of Certification Forms.
- Update contract administration procedures to explicitly distinguish between internal tracking systems (e.g., the BTB App, SharePoint, Google documents) and required contractual documentation, ensuring that internal system entries do not replace formal certification unless contract language is formally revised.
- Provide targeted guidance to contractors clarifying submission requirements and timing expectations.
- Implement periodic monitoring procedures to verify that Certification Forms are submitted timely and maintained in accordance with contract requirements.

Finding #2: Late or Missing Submission of Required Certification Forms

- A Vendor Information Session will be held in-person for all active contracted vendors to review the Fingerprinting requirements for both in-state and out-of-state vendors. (Summer 2026)
- Specifically highlighting:
 - Deadlines for document submission
 - Possible holds on POs until required forms are submitted
- Creation of a BSAP standardized document submission process will be implemented for the 26/27 SY (Summer 2026)

Recommendation No. 4: Page 13

Contract sponsor departments should strengthen oversight and ensure consistent implementation of Bulletin BUL-3872.2 by standardizing fingerprinting requirements and Certification Form expectations to:

- Provide formal training and written guidance to contract sponsor staff to ensure a clearer understanding of roles and responsibilities.
- Create a standardized, centralized system for the tracking and retention of clearance documentation submitted by contractors and sole proprietors and make it accessible to relevant District stakeholders.
- Establish monitoring and accountability mechanisms to ensure Certification Forms are collected, reviewed, and retained prior to the start of services.

Finding #4: Inconsistent Enforcement of Contractor Background Clearance Process Across Contract Sponsors

- A Vendor Information Session will be held in-person for all active contracted vendors to review the Fingerprinting requirements for both in-state and out-of-state vendors. (Summer 2026)
- Specifically highlighting:
 - Deadlines for document submission
 - Possible holds on POs until required forms are submitted
 - Maintaining Current staff rosters

RESPONSE FROM ETO

- School Sites are to implement a vendor staff sign-in procedure and compare sign-ins to the provided staff roster
- Clarification of the school staff's responsibilities for document upload to Ariba
- Creation of a BSAP standardized document submission process will be implemented for the 26/27 SY (Summer 2026)

Recommendation No. 6: Page 17

The contract sponsors should strengthen controls to ensure that contractor staff clearance information remains current and complete by:

- Establishing a standardized process for the submission, review, and retention of updated contractor staff clearance rosters when personnel changes occur, including defined submission frequency, required format, and responsible parties for receipt and verification.
- Implementing procedures to validate that updated staff rosters and Certification Forms accurately correspond to cleared individuals providing services to the District.

PSD should revise future BSAP, PFSS, and tutoring contract templates to explicitly require contractors to submit updated staff clearance rosters and Certification Form revisions in accordance with Bulletin BUL-3872.2. Incorporating these requirements into contracts will align contractual obligations with District policy and strengthen enforcement.

Finding #6: Inadequate Controls Over Contractor Staff Clearance Updates

- A Vendor Information Session will be held in-person for all active contracted vendors to review the Fingerprinting requirements for both in-state and out-of-state vendors. (Summer 2026)
- Specifically highlighting:
 - School sites will identify a Custodian of Record who will collect, maintain, and make all required documents available. upon request.
 - School sites will submit a monthly updated vendor staff roster to the BSAP standardized document submission process.

Recommendation No. 8: Page 21

The contract sponsors, in collaboration with school-site staff, should improve contractor clearance verification controls at the school level and ensure compliance with Bulletin BUL-3872.2 and the directives from the Division of School Operations by:

- Creating a centralized system for school sites to access and independently verify real-time contractor clearance status.
- Standardizing access control procedures by requiring photo identification checks and specific sign-in logs for contractors at all school sites.

RESPONSE FROM ETO

- Enhancing communication protocols for prompt notification of staffing changes and updated staff rosters before contractor personnel arrive at campuses.
- Providing ongoing targeted training for school-site staff to reinforce clearance requirements, verification procedures, and responsibilities under District policy.

Finding #8: Inconsistent Contractor Clearance Verification Practices Across School Sites

- A Vendor Information Session will be held in-person for all active contracted vendors to review the Fingerprinting requirements for both in-state and out-of-state vendors. (Summer 2026)
- Specifically highlighting:
 - School sites will create a document collection system for certification forms and will maintain documents on-site
 - School sites will develop a seamless vendor check-in system comprised of, but not limited to:
 - Sign-in sheet
 - Request for photo ID
 - Vendor staff roster for verification

RESPONSE FROM ODCE



Fingerprinting Audit Response
Office of Development & Civic Engagement

**Performance Audit of Contractor Fingerprinting
Compliance for Student Safety**

Recommendation No. 2

As the primary points of contact, the contract sponsors should strengthen controls to improve contractor compliance by establishing a standardized process that includes the following:

- Clearly communicate that submission of Certification Forms is mandatory under all applicable contracts, regardless of internal contractor tracking systems.
- Ensure the consistent receipt, tracking, and retention of Certification Forms.
- Update contract administration procedures to explicitly distinguish between internal tracking systems (e.g., the BTB App, SharePoint, Google documents) and required contractual documentation, ensuring that internal system entries do not replace formal certification unless contract language is formally revised.
- Provide targeted guidance to contractors clarifying submission requirements and timing expectations.
- Implement periodic monitoring procedures to verify that Certification Forms are submitted timely and maintained in accordance with contract requirements.
- Before the end of SY 2025–26, PFSS contractors will be notified that annual submission of Certification Forms through a [Google Form](#) is required before services may begin each school year.
- Contractors will also be required to submit updated Certification Forms to the Office of Development and Civic Engagement (ODCE), the school, and Procurement Services whenever personnel changes occur.
- Additionally, ODCE will collaborate with Procurement Services to update contract language by September 2026 to reflect these requirements.

Recommendation No. 4

RESPONSE FROM ODCE



Fingerprinting Audit Response Office of Development & Civic Engagement

Contract sponsor departments should strengthen oversight and ensure consistent implementation of Bulletin BUL-3872.2 by standardizing fingerprinting requirements and Certification Form expectations to:

- Provide formal training and written guidance to contract sponsor staff to ensure a clearer understanding of roles and responsibilities.
- Create a standardized, centralized system for the tracking and retention of clearance documentation submitted by contractors and sole proprietors, and make it accessible to relevant District stakeholders.
- Establish monitoring and accountability mechanisms to ensure Certification Forms are collected, reviewed, and retained prior to the start of services.
- ODCE will update the PFSS Handbook by August 2026 to require submission of Certification Forms and timely updates when vendor staffing changes occur.
- The Handbook and related guidance will also be posted on the program webpage for public access.
- ODCE will get input from other Divisions to develop a training video for vendors and schools by August 2026.

Recommendation No. 6

The contract sponsors should strengthen controls to ensure that contractor staff clearance information remains current and complete by:

- Establishing a standardized process for the submission, review, and retention of updated contractor staff clearance rosters when personnel changes occur, including defined submission frequency, required format, and responsible parties for receipt and verification.
- Implementing procedures to validate that updated staff rosters and Certification Forms accurately correspond to cleared individuals providing services to the District.

PSD should revise future BSAP, PFSS, and tutoring contract templates to explicitly require contractors to submit updated staff clearance rosters and Certification Form revisions in accordance with Bulletin BUL-3872.2.

RESPONSE FROM ODCE



Fingerprinting Audit Response

Office of Development & Civic Engagement

Incorporating these requirements into contracts will align contractual obligations with District policy and strengthen enforcement.

- PFSS contractors will submit Certification Forms through a Google Form before the end of July 2026 to ensure all forms are received before the start of the new school year.
- ODCE will get input from other Divisions to develop a training video for vendors and schools by August 2026.

Recommendation No. 8

The contract sponsors, in collaboration with school-site staff, should improve contractor clearance verification controls at the school level and ensure compliance with Bulletin BUL-3872.2 and the directives from the Division of School Operations by:

- Creating a centralized system for school sites to access and independently verify real-time contractor clearance status.
- Standardizing access control procedures by requiring photo identification checks and specific sign-in logs for contractors at all school sites.
- Enhancing communication protocols for prompt notification of staffing changes and updated staff rosters before contractor personnel arrive at campuses.
- Providing ongoing targeted training for school-site staff to reinforce clearance requirements, verification procedures, and responsibilities under District policy.
- In SY 2026–27, ODCE will provide schools with a shared folder containing all submitted Certification Forms and an updated PFSS Handbook outlining the steps required to comply with fingerprinting and background check requirements.
- ODCE will also make a recorded training available to schools and vendors.
- Additionally, ODCE will verify vendor staff rosters during service observation visits and work with schools to obtain sign-in logs to cross-reference against Certification Forms on file and monitor compliance.

RESPONSES FROM DOI AND BTB



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June 11, 2026

Ms. Joanna Vuong, Principal Auditor
LAUSD Office of the Inspector General (OIG)
VIA EMAIL: joanna.vuong@lausd.net

Dear Ms. Vuong,

The following is in response to the May 6, 2026, *Performance Audit of Contractor Fingerprinting Compliance for Student Safety*. The results of the audit indicated the following:

FINDING NO. 2 - LATE OR MISSING SUBMISSION OF REQUIRED CERTIFICATION FORMS

Tutoring services and after-school programs contracts require contractors to submit a written certification. This certification must confirm that all contractor staff members who may interact with students have successfully completed and cleared the necessary fingerprinting and background checks before they begin working with the District.

OIG RECOMMENDATION:

As the primary points of contact, the contract sponsors should strengthen controls to improve contractor compliance by establishing a standardized process that includes the following:

- Clearly communicate that submission of Certification Forms is mandatory under all applicable contracts, regardless of internal contractor tracking systems.
- Ensure the consistent receipt, tracking, and retention of Certification Forms.
- Update contract administration procedures to explicitly distinguish between internal tracking systems (e.g., the BTB App, SharePoint, Google documents) and required contractual documentation, ensuring that internal system entries do not replace formal certification unless contract language is formally revised.
- Provide targeted guidance to contractors clarifying submission requirements and timing expectations.
- Implement periodic monitoring procedures to verify that Certification Forms are submitted timely and maintained in accordance with contract requirements.

RESPONSES FROM DOI AND BTB

AFTER SCHOOL PROGRAM RESPONSE:

Beyond the Bell (BTB) will provide written notification to contracted After-School Program Providers that Certification Forms are due by July 31.

To ensure compliance, BTB will establish standardized procedures for the consistent collection, tracking, and retention of Certification Forms from After-School Program Providers. Providers will receive advance notice of submission deadlines through a written schedule, and BTB will maintain a monthly tracker to verify receipt of all required forms.

To further support compliance, BTB will provide After-School Program Providers with a written monthly schedule of all due dates and reporting requirements. BTB will also conduct periodic monitoring to verify that Certification Forms are submitted on time and are complete.

Date for Action:

- Written notification and Certification Forms: **July 31, 2026**
- Monthly tracking and monitoring procedures: **August 1, 2026, and ongoing**

TUTORING SERVICES RESPONSE:

Tutoring Services will provide written notification to contracted tutoring vendors that Certification Forms are due by July 31, 2026.

Key actions include clearly communicating that submission of Certification Forms is mandatory under all applicable contracts, regardless of any internal contractor tracking systems. Tutoring Services will implement monitoring procedures that include clear contractor instructions, regular reviews for incomplete or missing records, and follow-up procedures to promptly address discrepancies.

Date for Action:

- Written notification and Certification Forms: **July 31, 2026**
- Monitoring and follow-up procedures: **August 1, 2026 and ongoing**

FINDING NO. 3 - INCOMPLETE STAFF CLEARANCE INFORMATION IN THE BTB APP

The after-school program contract requires contractors to ensure that staff members who may have contact with students are fingerprinted and cleared through the DOJ prior to working at school sites, and to maintain an updated, site-specific list of all staff assigned to those sites.

In practice, BTB instructed contractors to enter staff Live Scan clearance dates into the BTB App to track clearance verification. To determine whether clearance information was properly recorded in the system, the OIG reviewed 97 staff members assigned to 10 school sites across 5 sampled after-school program contractors. The review identified the following:

- 52 of 97 staff members (54%) had clearance information recorded in the BTB App.
- 14 of 97 staff members (14%) had clearance information recorded in SharePoint instead of the BTB App.
- 26 of 97 staff members (27%) had no clearance information recorded in either system.

RESPONSES FROM DOI AND BTB

- 5 of 97 staff members (5%) had no clearance information recorded in either system because they were no longer employed by the contractors.

OIG RECOMMENDATION:

If the BTB App is intended to serve as the primary tool for tracking contractor clearance, BTB should ensure that contract language and policy requirements align with this use. Additionally, BTB should strengthen oversight by implementing a formal monitoring process that includes: (a) clear instructions to contractors on required data entry procedures; (b) periodic reviews to identify missing or incomplete clearance records; and (c) follow-up procedures to ensure timely correction of discrepancies.

BTB RESPONSE:

1. BTB will develop and distribute a job aid to all After-School Program Contractors outlining data entry procedures, required documentation, and timelines for maintaining accurate staff clearance records in the BTB App.
2. BTB will conduct monthly reviews of After-School Program Contractor clearance records to identify missing, incomplete, or expired information. Compliance reports will be shared with contractors and will include clearance dates and compliance status. The SharePoint compliance tracker will continue to utilize conditional formatting to identify records with TB tests expiring within 90 days, expired TB tests, and missing or expired TB or fingerprint information.
3. BTB will establish and communicate deadlines for correcting identified discrepancies. Contractors will be required to update records within the specified timeframe. BTB will conduct follow-up reviews to verify that corrections have been completed and that all staff remain compliant with clearance requirements.

Date for Action:

- Written notification and Certification Forms: **July 31, 2026**
- Job aid developed and distributed: **August 15, 2026**
- Monthly compliance review process, discrepancy correction, and follow-up monitoring: **August 1, 2026 and ongoing**

FINDING NO. 4 - INCONSISTENT ENFORCEMENT OF CONTRACTOR BACKGROUND CLEARANCE PROCESSES ACROSS CONTRACT SPONSORS

According to current and prior District bulletins, the contract sponsor (defined as either the District school or central office department initiating the contract for services) is responsible for enforcing site level access controls to prevent unauthorized individuals from working with students. This includes (1) obtaining and retaining Certification Forms prior to the start of services, and (2) ensuring that only individuals who have completed the DOJ background check and are listed on the Certification Forms are permitted to enter school sites or interact with students.

Across the four sampled program areas, contract sponsors demonstrated varying approaches to implementing the District's fingerprinting and background check requirements. While Bulletin BUL 3872.2 assigns contract sponsors the responsibility for verifying contractor clearance,

RESPONSES FROM DOI AND BTB

maintaining Certification Forms, and enforcing site-level access controls, implementation practices differed by contract sponsor departments.

Variations included the use of digital systems rather than Certification Forms, reliance on contractors to maintain clearance documentation, centralized tracking methods not accessible to school sites, and evolving practices intended to align with updated bulletin requirements. As a result, documentation practices and verification procedures differed significantly across programs, and the ability to confirm that only cleared individuals were present at school sites was either inconsistent or nonexistent.

OIG RECOMMENDATION:

Contract sponsor departments should strengthen oversight and ensure consistent implementation of Bulletin BUL-3872.2 by standardizing fingerprinting requirements and Certification Form expectations to:

- Provide formal training and written guidance to contract sponsor staff to ensure a clearer understanding of roles and responsibilities.
- Create a standardized, centralized system for the tracking and retention of clearance documentation submitted by contractors and sole proprietors and make it accessible to relevant District stakeholders.
- Establish monitoring and accountability mechanisms to ensure Certification Forms are collected, reviewed, and retained prior to the start of services.

AFTER SCHOOL PROGRAM RESPONSE:

BTB will provide written guidance, including job aids and procedures, to contracted After-School Program Providers to clarify clearance documentation requirements, Certification Form submission requirements, and compliance timelines. This information will also be reviewed during the annual provider start-up meeting prior to the beginning of each school year.

BTB maintains centralized tracking systems through SharePoint and the BTB Attendance App to monitor contractor compliance with clearance requirements. These systems allow BTB Central Office staff to track clearance dates, monitor submission status, and identify missing or expired records. The BTB Attendance App serves as a supplemental monitoring tool and does not replace required Certification Forms or the SharePoint compliance tracking process.

BTB will continue to implement monitoring and accountability measures to ensure Certification Forms are collected, reviewed, and retained prior to the start of services. These measures include deadline notifications, monthly compliance tracking, periodic record reviews, and follow-up procedures to address missing or incomplete documentation.

Date for Action:

- Written guidance and job aids distributed: **August 1, 2026**
- Annual provider start-up training conducted: **July 2026**
- Monthly compliance monitoring and tracking procedures: **August 1, 2026 and ongoing**

TUTORING SERVICES RESPONSE:

Tutoring Services will strengthen compliance, oversight, and accountability related to Fingerprint Certification Forms and contractor clearance requirements by clearly communicating that submission of Certification Forms is mandatory under all applicable contracts, regardless of any internal contractor tracking systems. Tutoring Services will ensure

RESPONSES FROM DOI AND BTB

the consistent receipt, tracking, review, and retention of all required Certification Forms and supporting documentation.

Tutoring Services will establish formal communication and coordination protocols with Procurement Services Division (PSD), Human Resources (HR), Risk Management (RM), and other responsible District offices to improve the timely notification, processing, and sharing of contractor clearance information. Tutoring Services will support the implementation of a centralized and standardized record-retention and tracking process for Certification Forms and fingerprint clearance documentation.

Tutoring Services will provide formal training and written guidance to contract sponsor staff to ensure a clear understanding of roles, responsibilities, and contractor clearance requirements under Bulletin BUL-3872.2. Division-specific responsibilities will be documented and communicated to promote consistent implementation and accountability.

In addition, Tutoring Services will implement monitoring procedures to ensure Certification Forms are collected, reviewed, and retained prior to the start of services. Contractors will receive targeted guidance regarding submission requirements and timelines, and periodic monitoring reviews will be conducted to verify timely submission and compliance with contract requirements.

Date for Action:

- Written guidance issued: **August 1, 2026**
- Training for contract vendor staff completed: **September 30, 2026**
- Monitoring and accountability procedures implemented: **August 1, 2026 and ongoing**
- Periodic compliance reviews conducted: **Beginning October 2026 and ongoing**

FINDING NO. 8 – INCONSISTENT CONTRACTOR CLEARANCE VERIFICATION PRACTICES ACROSS SCHOOL SITES

At the school site level, District fingerprinting bulletin requirements and related guidance from the Division of School Operations require schools to:

- Obtain completed Certification Forms prior to the start of contractor services and maintain these records on site.
- Ensure that only contractor personnel who have completed the required DOJ background check and are listed on Certification Forms or approved rosters are permitted to enter campuses or interact with students, including during virtual services.
- Monitor contractor staff member presence and activities to ensure compliance with District safety procedures and contract requirements.

In addition, school administrators are expected to:

- Maintain current records of approved contractor personnel.
- Enforce identification and check-in procedures, including photo ID verification and use of contractor badges.
- Maintain contractor-specific sign-in logs separate from general visitor logs.
- Ensure timely communication of contractor staffing changes to allow verification of clearance prior to new personnel reporting to the site.

RESPONSES FROM DOI AND BTB

Responses to the OIG's questionnaire from 36 school administrators, reflecting their understanding of the role and responsibility for contractor clearance procedures, varied across school sites:

- 21 of 36 schools (58%) relied on District-level processes and assumed contractor personnel were cleared prior to arrival.
- 10 of 36 schools (28%) relied on contractors to ensure clearance without independently verifying documentation.
- 5 of 36 schools (14%) verified clearance by checking whether contractor names appeared on submitted Certification Forms or rosters.

OIG RECOMMENDATION:

The contract sponsors, in collaboration with school-site staff, should improve contractor clearance verification controls at the school level and ensure compliance with Bulletin BUL-3872.2 and the directives from the Division of School Operations by:

- Creating a centralized system for school sites to access and independently verify real-time contractor clearance status.
- Standardizing access control procedures by requiring photo identification checks and specific sign-in logs for contractors at all school sites.
- Enhancing communication protocols for prompt notification of staffing changes and updated staff rosters before contractor personnel arrive at campuses.
- Providing ongoing targeted training for school-site staff to reinforce clearance requirements, verification procedures, and responsibilities under District policy.

AFTER SCHOOL PROGRAM RESPONSE:

Contracted After-School Program Providers will submit certified staff rosters monthly that identify all cleared staff assigned to each school site. BTB will review, compile, and distribute updated rosters to school administrators to support accurate site-level records and facilitate verification of approved personnel.

BTB will continue conducting monthly site visits to monitor contractor compliance with District requirements. During these visits, BTB staff will verify staff sign-in records, review site rosters, and observe program operations to ensure only approved staff are present and that personnel are wearing approved, identifiable attire consistent with program requirements.

BTB will also strengthen communication with school administrators by providing updated contractor staffing information and supporting documentation on a regular basis to ensure schools have access to current records for verification purposes.

Date for Action:

- Monthly certified staff roster process implemented: **August 1, 2026**
- Distribution of updated rosters to school administrators: **August 2026 and ongoing**
- Monthly site monitoring and verification procedures: **Ongoing beginning August 2026**
- Enhanced school-site communication protocols implemented: **August 2026 and ongoing**

TUTORING SERVICES RESPONSE:

Tutoring Services will strengthen school-site access control procedures by supporting the use of photo identification verification and standardized contractor sign-in logs at participating

RESPONSES FROM DOI AND BTB

school sites. Tutoring Services will also enhance communication protocols to ensure timely notification of staffing changes and the distribution of updated contractor staff rosters before personnel begin providing services.

Schools will receive updated lists of approved tutoring personnel on a regular basis, but no less than monthly, to support site-level verification and oversight. Tutoring Services will work with contractors to ensure staffing updates are communicated promptly and that roster information remains current and accurate.

We will strengthen school-site access control procedures by supporting requirements for photo identification checks and standardized contractor sign-in logs at all school sites. We will also enhance communication protocols to ensure prompt notification of staffing changes and updated contractor staff rosters before personnel arrive on campus by providing schools with access to updated lists on a regular basis, but no less than once per month.

Date for Action:

- Communication protocols for staffing updates established: **August 1, 2026**
- Monthly distribution of approved contractor staff rosters to schools: **August 2026 and ongoing**
- School-site access control and sign-in procedures communicated to contractors and schools: **August 2026**
- Ongoing monitoring of contractor staffing and roster updates: **August 2026 and ongoing**

RESPONSE FROM PSD

INTER-OFFICE CORRESPONDENCE LOS ANGELES UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT

TO: Josh Margraf, Assistant Inspector General, Audits
Office of the Inspector General

Date: June 17, 2026

FROM: Matthew A. Friedman, Chief Procurement Officer
Procurement Services Department

**SUBJECT: RESPONSE TO DRAFT REPORT ON THE PERFORMANCE AUDIT OF
CONTRACTOR FINGERPRINTING COMPLIANCE FOR STUDENT SAFETY**

The following is in response to the draft report on the performance audit of Contractor fingerprinting compliance for student safety. The results of the audit indicated the following:

Recommendation No. 5: Page 14

Report states: "The District should improve coordination, accountability, and documentation controls among the PSD, HR, and RM divisions to ensure consistent adherence to fingerprinting and clearance requirements as outlined in the current bulletin guidance. To prevent the issues that arose under previous bulletins, the District should implement the following measures:

- Establish formalized communication and coordination protocols among PSD, HR, and RM to improve timely notification, processing, and sharing of contractor clearance information, including sole proprietor fingerprinting requirements.
- Implement a centralized and standardized tracking and record-retention system for Certification Forms and fingerprint clearance documentation that is accessible to all responsible divisions to support verification and oversight.
- Clarify and document division-specific responsibilities under Bulletin BUL-3872.2, including how division roles apply to both current contracts and legacy contracts executed under prior bulletin versions, to ensure consistent interpretation and implementation.
- Conduct a reconciliation review of existing contractor and sole proprietor records to identify and address missing or incomplete clearance documentation where feasible."

PSD Response:

PSD agrees with Recommendation No. 5. PSD is working closely with HR and RM to ensure coordination and carry out the procedures outlined in BUL-3872.2 In accordance with the bulletin, PSD will continue providing the Fingerprint and Criminal Background Check Certification form to Contractors, receive copies of the completed forms, and upload the forms to Contractors' vendor profiles in the Ariba system. Copies of the Certification forms will be provided to Contract Sponsors. Further, PSD will work with HR, RM, and Division of School Operations to explore options for a centralized and standardized tracking record retention system that Contract Sponsors can access and will be accountable for verifying Contractors' fingerprinting status.

Date for action: January 2027

RESPONSE FROM PSD

Recommendation No. 6: Page 16

Report states: "The contract sponsors should strengthen controls to ensure that contractor staff clearance information remains current and complete by:

- Establishing a standardized process for the submission, review, and retention of updated contractor staff clearance rosters when personnel changes occur, including defined submission frequency, required format, and responsible parties for receipt and verification.
- Implementing procedures to validate that updated staff rosters and Certification Forms accurately correspond to cleared individuals providing services to the District.

PSD should revise future BSAP, PFSS, and tutoring contract templates to explicitly require contractors to submit updated staff clearance rosters and Certification Form revisions in accordance with Bulletin BUL-3872.2. Incorporating these requirements into contracts will align contractual obligations with District policy and strengthen enforcement."

PSD Response:

PSD agrees with Recommendation No. 6. PSD will ensure that contract templates are updated to reflect the requirements and procedures for Contractors to submit revised Certification forms when personnel changes occur. PSD will issue amendments to BSAP and PFSS contracts to include the applicable requirements and procedures. When received, copies of revised Certification forms will be provided to Contract Sponsors.

Date for action: January 2027

Recommendation No. 7: Page 18

Report states: "PSD should standardize fingerprinting and background check language across all future contract templates to ensure full alignment with Bulletin BUL-3872.2 and any program-related policies. Standardizing the required provisions (while allowing program-specific operational adjustments where necessary) promotes consistent implementation, strengthens oversight, and improves the District's ability to demonstrate compliance with applicable laws and internal policies.

Based on the conditions or recommendations noted in Finding Nos. 1, 3, and 6, PSD should also incorporate the following contract provisions to clarify requirements applicable to specific contract or program categories:

- Background clearance requirements for out-of-state contractors, including acceptable documentation and verification standards.
- Options and guidance for alternative system-based certification, such as the use of the BTB App for validating clearance.
- Mandatory submission of updated staff rosters and Certification Forms to reflect any changes in contractor personnel to prevent lapses in current and accurate clearance information."

RESPONSE FROM PSD

PSD Response:

PSD agrees with Recommendation No. 7. PSD will ensure that contract templates include requirements and procedures related to personnel changes, fingerprinting for out of state contractors, alternative system-based certifications (when applicable), and submission of updated Certification forms.

Date for action: January 2027

RESPONSE FROM RM

INTER-OFFICE CORRESPONDENCE

LOS ANGELES UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT

TO: Josh Margraf, Assistant Inspector General, Audits
Office of the Inspector General

Date: July 22, 2026

FROM: Amalia Sanchez, Insurance Manager
Risk Finance and Insurance Service, Risk Management Department

SUBJECT: RESPONSE TO DRAFT REPORT ON THE PERFORMANCE AUDIT OF
CONTRACTOR FINGERPRINTING COMPLIANCE FOR STUDENT SAFETY

The following is in response to the draft report on the performance audit of Contractor fingerprinting compliance for student safety. The results of the audit indicated the following:

Finding No. 5 (page 13) – Lack of Coordination and Documentation Controls Over Contractor Clearance Processes Across District Divisions.

Report: Recommendation No. 5 (page 14)

“The District should improve coordination, accountability, and documentation controls among the PSD, HR, and RM divisions to ensure consistent adherence to fingerprinting and clearance requirements as outlined in the current bulletin guidance. To prevent the issues that arose under previous bulletins, the District should implement the following measures:

- Establish formalized communication and coordination protocols among PSD, HR, and RM to improve timely notification, processing, and sharing of contractor clearance information, including sole proprietor fingerprinting requirements.
- Implement a centralized and standardized tracking and record-retention system for Certification Forms and fingerprint clearance documentation that is accessible to all responsible divisions to support verification and oversight.
- Clarify and document division-specific responsibilities under Bulletin BUL-3872.2, including how division roles apply to both current contracts and legacy contracts executed under prior bulletin versions, to ensure consistent interpretation and implementation.
- Conduct a reconciliation review of existing contractor and sole proprietor records to identify and address missing or incomplete clearance documentation where feasible.”

Risk Finance Plan:

Risk Finance agrees with Recommendation No. 5. Risk Finance will work closely with Human Resources and Procurement to clarify Risk Finance’s role of the fingerprinting process and ensure coordination and implementation of a process that will strengthen the objectives of BUL-3872.2 In accordance with the bulletin, Risk Finance will continue to store/file Fingerprint and Criminal Background Check Certification forms and establish a tracking system. Further, Risk Finance will work with Human Resources and Procurement to determine a centralized record retention system and process that allows contract sponsors to access, verify, and manage contractors results.

Target Date for Action: January 2027

Page 1

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